PlacementConnect - Acceptance Criteria

1. Authentication and Access

AC-AUTH-01 — Student registration

- **Given** a guest provides a valid, unused username, email and password and selects Student
- **When** the registration form is submitted
- **Then** a Student user and associated Student profile are created
- **And** the password is stored as a hash, not plaintext
- **And** duplicate username or email is rejected.

AC-AUTH-02 — Company registration

- **Given** a guest provides valid, unused credentials and selects Company
- **When** registration is submitted
- **Then** a Company user and associated Company profile are created
- **And** the company approval status is Pending by default.

AC-AUTH-03 — Role mismatch

- **Given** a valid account exists for one role
- **When** the user attempts to log in through a different role's login flow
- **Then** access is denied.

AC-AUTH-04 — Disabled or blacklisted account

- **Given** an account status is Disabled or Blacklisted
- **When** the user attempts to log in
- **Then** login is denied with an explanatory error.

AC-AUTH-05 — Company approval gate

- **Given** a company account has Pending or Rejected approval status
- **When** the company attempts to log in
- **Then** login is denied and the approval state is communicated.

AC-AUTH-06 — Protected route access

- **Given** a user is unauthenticated or has the wrong role
- **When** the user navigates to a protected frontend route
- **Then** the router redirects to the appropriate login or the user's own dashboard.
- **And** the backend independently rejects unauthorised API requests.

2. Profiles

AC-PROF-01 — Student profile retrieval and update

- **Given** an authenticated student
- **When** the student opens and updates their profile with valid data
- **Then** the profile fields and associated education, experience and project data are persisted
- **And** the updated profile is returned.

AC-PROF-02 — CGPA validation

- **Given** a student submits a CGPA outside the inclusive range 0.00–10.00
- **When** the profile update is processed
- **Then** the update is rejected with a validation message.

AC-PROF-03 — Company profile ownership

- **Given** an authenticated company
- **When** it retrieves or updates its profile
- **Then** only the profile associated with that company account is returned or changed.

AC-PROF-04 — Profile deletion

- **Given** an authenticated user requests profile deletion
- **When** the request is processed
- **Then** the user's profile deletion workflow is executed
- **And** the product warns about related records that may be deleted or affected.

3. Admin Governance

AC-ADM-01 — Approve pending company

- **Given** a company has Pending approval status
- **When** an administrator approves it
- **Then** its approval status becomes Approved
- **And** it becomes eligible for company login, subject to account status.

AC-ADM-02 — Reject pending company

- **Given** a company has Pending approval status
- **When** an administrator rejects it
- **Then** its approval status becomes Rejected
- **And** company login remains blocked.

AC-ADM-03 — Reapprove rejected company

- **Given** a company has Rejected approval status
- **When** an administrator reapproves it
- **Then** its approval status becomes Approved.

AC-ADM-04 — Manage account status

- **Given** an administrator selects disable, enable, blacklist or whitelist for a company or student
- **When** the action is processed
- **Then** the related User.status is updated only when the current state permits the transition
- **And** the relevant dashboard caches are invalidated.

AC-ADM-05 — Approve or reject drive

- **Given** a drive has Pending approval status
- **When** an administrator approves or rejects it
- **Then** its approval status changes accordingly
- **And** student discovery reflects the updated approval status.

AC-ADM-06 — Reapprove rejected drive

- **Given** a drive has Rejected approval status
- **When** an administrator reapproves it
- **Then** its approval status becomes Approved.

AC-ADM-07 — Admin application inspection

- **Given** an administrator selects a company, drive or student
- **When** the relevant application list or detail is requested
- **Then** the matching application records are returned.

4. Drive Management

AC-DRV-01 — Create drive

- **Given** an authenticated company submits all required drive fields with valid values
- **When** it creates a drive
- **Then** a drive associated with that company is persisted
- **And** its approval status defaults to Pending.

AC-DRV-02 — Validate drive dates

- **Given** a company submits an application start or deadline in the past
- **When** it creates or updates a drive
- **Then** the request is rejected.
- **And** when start is greater than or equal to deadline, the request is rejected.

AC-DRV-03 — Validate salary and CGPA

- **Given** a company submits a negative salary or a minimum CGPA outside 0–10
- **When** the drive is saved
- **Then** validation fails.

AC-DRV-04 — Company ownership of drive

- **Given** Company A is authenticated and Drive B belongs to Company B
- **When** Company A attempts to retrieve, update or delete Drive B
- **Then** the operation is denied or the drive is not found.

AC-DRV-05 — Student sees approved opportunities only

- **Given** a company is Approved and Active and a drive is Approved
- **When** a student browses companies and drives
- **Then** the approved company and drive are discoverable.
- **And** pending/rejected drives, unapproved companies and inactive company accounts are not discoverable.

AC-DRV-06 — Drive phase calculation

- **Given** a drive has an application start and deadline
- **When** current IST time is before start
- **Then** the phase is Upcoming.
- **When** current IST time is within the inclusive start/deadline window
- **Then** the phase is Ongoing.
- **When** current IST time is after deadline
- **Then** the phase is Closed.

5. Student Applications

AC-APP-01 — Successful application

- **Given** a student is eligible, the drive is approved and visible, the current time is within the application window, and no application exists
- **When** the student applies
- **Then** an application is created with status Applied.

AC-APP-02 — Application before opening

- **Given** current time is earlier than application_start
- **When** the student attempts to apply
- **Then** the application is rejected because applications have not opened.

AC-APP-03 — Application after deadline

- **Given** current time is later than application_deadline
- **When** the student attempts to apply
- **Then** the application is rejected because applications are closed.

AC-APP-04 — CGPA ineligibility

- **Given** a drive has a minimum CGPA greater than the student's CGPA

- **When** the student attempts to apply
- **Then** the application is rejected as ineligible.

AC-APP-05 — Duplicate application

- **Given** the student already has an application for the drive
- **When** the student attempts to apply again
- **Then** the duplicate application is rejected.

AC-APP-06 — Successful withdrawal

- **Given** the student's application status is Applied and current time is within the drive application window
- **When** the student withdraws
- **Then** the application record is deleted.

AC-APP-07 — Withdrawal after processing

- **Given** the application status is Shortlisted or Rejected
- **When** the student attempts to withdraw
- **Then** withdrawal is rejected.

AC-APP-08 — Withdrawal outside window

- **Given** current time is before application_start or after application_deadline
- **When** the student attempts to withdraw
- **Then** withdrawal is rejected.

6. Recruiter Processing and Placement

AC-REC-01 — View own applicants

- **Given** a company has an approved drive
- **When** it requests the drive's applications
- **Then** only applications belonging to its own drive are returned.

AC-REC-02 — Reject applicant

- **Given** an application is Applied
- **When** the company changes application status to Rejected
- **Then** application status becomes Rejected.

AC-REC-03 — Shortlist requires interview details

- **Given** an application is Applied
- **When** the company changes status to Shortlisted without interview mode, start date-time or end date-time
- **Then** the update is rejected.

- **When** all required interview details are supplied and valid
- **Then** application status becomes Shortlisted and a Scheduled interview record is created.

AC-REC-04 — Interview date validation

- **Given** interview date-times are supplied
- **When** either date-time is in the past or start is not before end
- **Then** the update is rejected.

AC-REC-05 — Interview outcome Not Selected

- **Given** an interview is Scheduled
- **When** the company marks it Not Selected
- **Then** interview status becomes Not Selected.

AC-REC-06 — Interview outcome Selected requires joining date

- **Given** an interview is Scheduled
- **When** the company marks it Selected without a joining date-time
- **Then** the update is rejected.
- **When** a valid future joining date-time is supplied
- **Then** interview status becomes Selected and a Placement record is created with status Offered.

AC-REC-07 — Placement outcome

- **Given** a placement record has status Offered
- **When** the company updates it to Accepted or Declined
- **Then** the corresponding placement status is persisted.

AC-REC-08 — Terminal state protection

- **Given** an application, interview or placement is in a terminal state
- **When** a user attempts a transition to a different state
- **Then** the update is rejected by current service rules.

7. Dashboards, Inbox and Exports

AC-DASH-01 — Student dashboard

- **Given** an authenticated student
- **When** the dashboard is loaded
- **Then** the response includes drive phase, eligibility and application-stage/performance information.

AC-DASH-02 — Company dashboard

- **Given** an authenticated company

- **When** the dashboard is loaded
- **Then** the response includes its drive and application/interview/placement metrics.

AC-DASH-03 — Admin dashboard

- **Given** an authenticated administrator
- **When** the dashboard is loaded
- **Then** platform-level placement metrics are returned.

AC-MSG-01 — Role-specific inbox

- **Given** an authenticated user
- **When** the user opens the inbox
- **Then** only notifications available to that role/user context are returned.

AC-MSG-02 — Notification detail and attachment

- **Given** a notification belongs to the authenticated user's inbox
- **When** the user opens the notification and requests an attachment
- **Then** the notification detail or permitted attachment is returned.
- **And** access to another user's notification/attachment is denied.

AC-EXP-01 — Export request

- **Given** an authenticated user requests a profile export
- **When** the export request is accepted
- **Then** the background export workflow is initiated and the user receives an appropriate acknowledgement.

8. Quality Checks

- All protected API operations reject unauthenticated requests.
- Every role-protected operation rejects a user with the wrong role.
- Server-side validation is applied even if the frontend validates the same field.
- Cache invalidation occurs after changes that affect dashboards.
- Errors are understandable and do not expose traces or sensitive data.
- Destructive operations require clear confirmation in the UI.
- Notification attachment paths cannot be used to access arbitrary server files.